

MEASURE	2001	2025	CHANGE	
SCALE AND ACADEMIC LEVEL				
International students in US higher education	548,000	1,180,000	2.15×	▲
International undergraduate students	254,000	357,000	+40.4%	▲
International graduate students	238,000	488,000	+105%	▲
Master's share of international enrollment	22.6%	26%	+3.4 pp	▲
Doctorate share of international enrollment	14.1%	13%	-1.1 pp	▼
OPT share of international enrollment	3.84%	25%	+21.1 pp	▲
GEOGRAPHIC CONCENTRATION				
International students from Asia	302,000	843,000	+179%	▲
Asia's share of international students	55.1%	71.6%	+16.4 pp	▲
China's share of international undergraduates	3.16%	22%	+18.8 pp	▲
China's share of international graduate students	19.7%	24.6%	+5.0 pp	▲
India's share of international undergraduates	4.7%	11.2%	+6.5 pp	▲
India's share of international graduate students	16.3%	36.4%	+20.1 pp	▲
South Korea's share of international graduate students	8.82%	3.04%	-5.8 pp	▼
Europe's share of international students	17.1%	7.93%	-9.2 pp	▼
Sub-Saharan Africa's share of international students	5.37%	5.55%	+0.2 pp	▲
CONCENTRATION BY STEM FIELD				
International students in math and computer science	67,800	305,000	+350%	▲
International students in engineering	83,400	217,000	+160%	▲
STEM students from India	72,200 ²⁰¹⁰	260,000	+261%	▲
STEM students from China	55,500 ²⁰¹⁰	138,000	+149%	▲
PROJECTED CHANGES TO INTERNATIONAL ENROLLMENT BETWEEN 2025 AND 2026				
Undergraduate enrollment	357,000 ²⁰²⁵	364,000*	+2%	▲
Graduate enrollment	488,000 ²⁰²⁵	430,000*	-12%	▼
OPT participation	294,000 ²⁰²⁵	335,000*	+14%	▲
RECRUITMENT AND BARRIERS (2015–2025)				
Top recruitment target	China: 65.8% ²⁰¹⁵	India: 53%	China → India	
Institutions citing China as a recruitment priority	65.8% ²⁰¹⁵	31%	-34.8 pp	▼
Institutions citing India as a recruitment priority	40.5% ²⁰¹⁵	53%	+12.5 pp	▲
Institutions citing South Korea as a recruitment priority	28.9% ²⁰¹⁵	33%	+4.1 pp	▲
Institutions citing visa application process	12% ²⁰¹⁵	96%	+84.0 pp	▲
Institutions citing feeling unwelcome in the US	49% ²⁰¹⁹	67%	+18.0 pp	▲
Institutions citing US social/political environment	58% ²⁰¹⁹	64%	+6.0 pp	▲
ECONOMIC CONTRIBUTION				
International-student contribution to the US economy	\$10.7B	\$56B	5.22×	▲

* Projected values are drawn directly from the Open Doors Fall 2025 snapshot's 2026 enrollment projection.

Note: Historical comparisons use 2001 and 2025 observations. Superscript years mark rows with a later earliest start point than 2001 or earlier latest endpoint than 2025. Arrow colors indicate direction of change only.

Source: Derived from the current report Figures and Tables: Figures 2.01–2.08, Tables 2.01–2.02.